

The "Canoa, Ecuador" Video Claim: Location Verification Findings

An examination of a September 2026 Facebook video in which Tim Ballard identifies a filming location as "Canoa, Ecuador" and ties it to a specific child-trafficking rescue claim, checked against (1) a separately-sourced 2025 raid video purporting to show the same house, and (2) independently-obtained satellite, OpenStreetMap, and street-level imagery of the actual town of Canoa.

PREPARED	2026-09-14
SUBJECT VIDEO	Facebook, post ID 14oSnuEnbDL ("Video B" throughout)
COMPARISON VIDEO	YouTube, wkBhvP_ONvM ("Video A" throughout)
SCOPE	Location and provenance only — not an assessment of the underlying trafficking claims

This memorandum states findings with their supporting basis and explicitly notes what each finding does and does not establish. Where a claim could not be independently verified, that is stated rather than assumed. Full source list and methodology in Section 5.

DISTRIBUTION

This memorandum, the source video files, and the watermarked exhibit clips referenced herein have been provided to the following parties. Both may be contacted directly to verify receipt.

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American Crime Journal (attn. Damion Moore, founder)

Investigative crime-journalism outlet maintaining a dedicated Tim Ballard coverage archive, including original source material

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1 Summary of Findings

- **The building Video A shows is not the building Video B shows.** Five independent structural features (balcony construction, ground-floor door count, wall material, roof shape, color scheme) are mismatched between the two — differences that would not plausibly change over an 18-month gap (Exhibit 2, Section 2).
- **Video B's most distinctive location detail — a painted sports court directly beside the house — does not match anything in the actual town of Canoa.** Independently obtained satellite imagery, OpenStreetMap's own crowdsourced feature data, and a street-level photograph of the town's actual plaza area were checked; the only sports facility documented anywhere in the town is an unrelated sand volleyball court (Exhibits 3–6, Section 3).
- **These findings support that Video B's on-camera location claim is false.** They do not, on their own, establish where Video B was actually filmed, or the authenticity of the video file itself — see Section 4 for the limits of what this method can and cannot show.

2 The Claim, and the Structural Mismatch

Video B (Facebook, Sept. 2026): Ballard, walking, names the location on camera and directly ties it to a specific claim:

"We are here in [Canoa], Ecuador, doing a lot of big programs to develop this beautiful town... We recognize this behind me. We've seen this house. That is the house depicted in Hidden War."

Video A (YouTube, re-uploaded March 2025, watermarked twice five days apart) is a separate video: a masked Ecuadorian police officer describing a raid at what the footage frames as the same "house" — devices and material involving children found on the premises, suspects described as Dutch nationals.



Exhibit 2. Left: the house shown in Video A (2025 raid footage). Right: the house Video B identifies as the same location (2026). Frontal shots, matched as closely as the two source videos allow.

FEATURE	VIDEO A HOUSE	VIDEO B HOUSE
Balcony construction	Two stacked levels, open rails, matching maroon-red slats	One enclosed room under a peaked roof [mismatch]
Ground floor	Solid wood wall, single arched door	Stucco wall, two arched doors plus a full gated entrance [mismatch]
Wall material	Wood-plank cladding throughout	Cream stucco (lower level), wood panel (middle level) only [mismatch]

Roof	Flat-topped rooftop patio addition	Peaked/gabled roof over the top room [mismatch]
Color scheme	Natural wood tone, maroon-red accents	Cream/tan, brown wood balcony [mismatch]

Shared elements between the two (arched windows, a palm tree in front, bamboo fencing) are common to the coastal-Ecuador building style generally and are not identifying features on their own. The mismatches above are structural — door count, roof shape, balcony construction — the kind of detail that does not change on an existing building over an 18-month span.

3 Checked Against the Real Town

"Canoa" is an actual, small coastal town in Manabí Province, Ecuador (confirmed via OpenStreetMap's place data). It was independently mapped for this memorandum using satellite imagery, OpenStreetMap's crowdsourced feature data, and a street-level photograph, to test Video B's most distinctive and most checkable visual detail: a painted sports court, directly beside the claimed house, visible in the video with a teal/tan/orange surface, a blue side wall, and a soccer goal frame.



Exhibit 3. The sports court as shown in Video B — painted surface, blue wall, goal frame, directly street-adjacent.

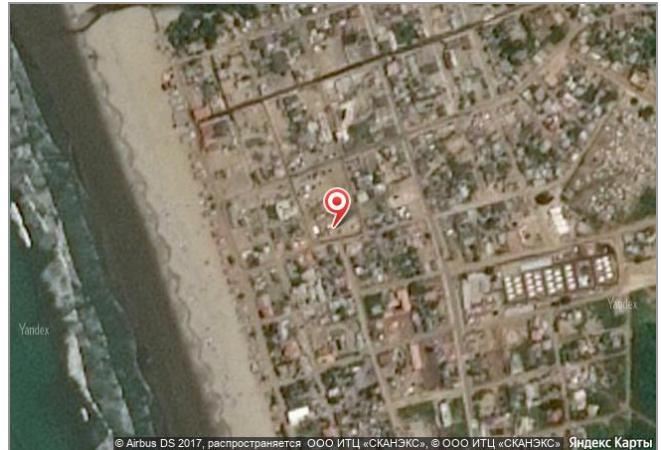


Exhibit 4. The only sports facility documented anywhere in Canoa by OpenStreetMap's crowdsourced data: a sand volleyball court. Different sport, different surface, no visual resemblance.

A painted, walled court with a goal frame is a distinctive structure that would be clearly visible from above. Canoa is a small town — on the order of 300–400 buildings in total — and no green/yellow/teal painted court of any kind appears anywhere in the satellite imagery reviewed. OpenStreetMap's own data for the town, which is otherwise detailed (a school, a cemetery, a paragliding operator, dozens of named streets, more than 60 named businesses), documents exactly one sports facility, and it is not this one.



Exhibit 5. Satellite overview of Canoa, oriented north, with the town's only OpenStreetMap-tagged park pinned for scale. The town is compact enough that a feature the size of a painted sports court would be identifiable if present.



Exhibit 6. A ground-level, dated photograph (2017-12-27) of Canoa's actual town-center plaza area, for direct visual comparison against Video B's street scene.

Video B also shows an unpaved street, which does not independently indicate anything: the street-level photograph above shows Canoa has at least some paved roads with painted lane markings, so paving status alone neither supports nor rules out a location.

4 What This Does and Does Not Establish

What it establishes

The specific, visually distinctive location detail in Video B most likely to confirm the on-camera location claim — the sports court — has no match anywhere in the actual town's mapped layout or satellite imagery. Combined with the structural building mismatch against Video A, this is affirmative evidence that Video B's stated location is false.

What it does not establish

This method cannot distinguish between (a) Video B being unaltered footage filmed at a different, actual location with a false on-camera location claim, and (b) Video B being synthetic or otherwise fabricated media. Both would produce an identical result under this test. Establishing which of those is the case would require a different form of analysis — forensic examination of the video file itself, for example — which has not been performed here. Satellite resolution limits and OpenStreetMap's inherent incompleteness for small towns also mean this check cannot fully rule out a very small structure.

5 Methodology and Sources

Video sources

- **Video A** — YouTube, ID `wkBhVP_ONvM`, re-uploaded to that platform with a burned-in watermark date of 2025-03-14; the underlying file's own original watermark reads 2025-03-09 (both visible simultaneously, confirming a re-upload of an already-watermarked source). Uploader credited on-platform as "Perl Gonzalez."
- **Video B** — Facebook, post ID `14oSnuEnbDL`, burned-in watermark date 2026-09-02, single watermark layer (consistent with first-generation watermarking of a freshly-posted clip rather than a re-upload).

Mapping and imagery sources (all pulled 2026-09-14; none require an account or API key)

- **Satellite imagery** — Yandex Maps' static-map service (`static-maps.yandex.ru`), sourcing commercial satellite imagery credited on-frame to Airbus DS, dated 2017. Google's equivalent static-map and Street View endpoints were attempted first and refused the request without an API key.
- **Place and feature data** — OpenStreetMap, via its public Nominatim search API (place lookup) and Overpass API (feature queries: named places, businesses, sports facilities, bridges, roads), both queried directly with no authentication.
- **Street-level photography** — KartaView (formerly OpenStreetCam), a crowdsourced street-level imagery platform, licensed CC BY-SA 4.0, queried via its public API (`api.openstreetcam.org`). The specific photograph used (Exhibit 6) is dated 2017-12-27 and is drawn from a single ~1,600-frame driving sequence through the town; additional frames from that sequence exist and were not all reviewed.

Verification note

Every image in this memorandum was captured directly from the sources listed above and is reproduced without alteration other than resizing and, where noted, the addition of a location pin or north-orientation marker for clarity. Exact request parameters (coordinates, zoom levels, query text) for every image are retained and available on request.